DBI HAWORTH
Best In Class Dealer

SUCCESS STORY



CUSTOMER: Michigan State University
PROJECT: Wellness & Flexible Meeting Hub (Room 155)
LOCATION: East Lansing, MI
INDUSTRY: Higher Education
SIZE: 520 sq. ft.

Following the tragic events on campus in February 2023, Room 155 became an impromptu safe space where students gathered to reflect, connect, and support one another. Seeing its importance, MSU partnered with DBI to create a permanent, adaptable wellness room that preserves its symbolic role as a place of safety and connection while still serving as a flexible faculty meeting space when needed.



THE CHALLENGE

The redesign needed to replace the cold, institutional finishes with softer, more inviting colors, calm the echoes, and do it all within 520 square feet – while classes carried on just outside the door. It also had to honor the space's new role as a place of comfort and connection for students in the wake of the tragedy.

- **A Welcoming, Calm Environment**
- **Meaningful and Functional Design**
- **Maintenance Friendly**

THE SOLUTION

ACOUSTIC FEATURE WALL:

A felt panel that fades from Spartan green to white frames a wood sign reading "You Belong Here" and tamps down harsh echo. The gradient honors school colors without turning the room into a shrine.

FURNITURE ON THE MOVE:

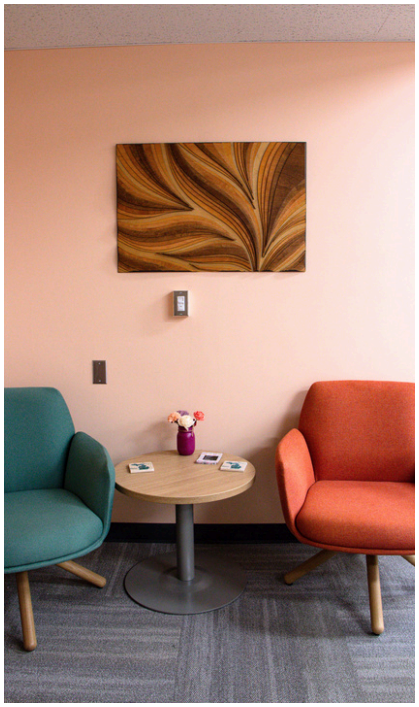
Four Haworth **Planes** flip-nest tables and **Jive** chairs glide aside for wellness circles or roll back into rows for twenty-person meetings–no reset crew required.

COMFORT & POWER ZONES:

Haworth **Poppy** lounge chairs, **Pip** laptop tables, and an **X-Series** media console create plug-in nooks for journaling, device charging, or virtual counseling.

COLLAGE WALL:

Haworth tackboards invite students to pin art and affirmations, ensuring the room evolves with its community.







BIOPHILIC TOUCHES:

A preserved-moss insert and low-care plants bring nature inside with. The moss wall - which doesn't need to be watered - has already shown up in dozens of student social posts. A quiet sign the space resonates.



PRODUCTS USED

- Haworth Poppy lounge
- Haworth Pip laptop tables
- Haworth Planes flip-nest tables
- Haworth Jive chairs
- Haworth X-Series media console
- Haworth tackboards
- Custom felt feature wall
- Preserved moss insert





DESIGNER'S PERSPECTIVE

"Designing this space, I felt a huge responsibility to create somewhere students could feel safe, recharge, and connect. Education is especially important to me because it supports so many students, and those moments – big and small – truly matter for their community and for our collective future. Watching this place transform from an anxious circle of chairs into a space that says, in every way possible, 'You belong here,' is the most meaningful project I've ever worked on."

- Stephanie Mapes

Senior Interior Designer, DBI

THE RESULTS

Quick change-over:
Mobile flip-nest furniture lets staff reset the room in minutes.

Trusted refuge:
Students drop in for reflection, small-group work, and scheduled meetings every day, proving its ongoing value.

Thoughtful finishes:
Soft, inviting surfaces reduce echoes and wipe clean easily, balancing comfort, calm, and practicality.

A NOTE FROM THE CLIENT:

"My vision was for a place where folks could connect, re-charge, and relax. It serves that purpose wonderfully. Several student groups have used it for events and like the relaxed and calm atmosphere, as well as the feeling of belonging that it promotes. The room has been a great addition to our School and the larger College community."

– Nancy Gray, Building Coordinator







THE DBI DIFFERENCE

MSU needed one partner to translate emotion into practical design. DBI led listening sessions, coordinated local fabricators, and leveraged Haworth's adaptable platforms to deliver a room that supports healing today and flexes for tomorrow.

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Want to create a space that becomes the heart of your campus?

Contact DBI today to discover how we can help design environments that support connection and empower your students.

dbiyes.com

912 East Michigan Ave. Lansing, MI 48912

(800) 968-1324